Listening

Read the following statements. Now, listen to the talk on the importance of humour and laughter for good physical and mental health. You may listen to the text again if required, to help you choose the correct option.

i) Humour has the power to motivate and _____ stress and pain.

a) improve b)intensify
c) reduce d) increase

ii) It seems generally _____ that our bodies respond in a positive way to a hearty laugh.

a) accepted b) denied
c) improved d) confused

iii) The _____ is stocked with books, comics, funny posters, audiotapes, and videos.

a) waiting room b) humour room
c) ICU d) reception

iv) One can plan to use humour yet rely on _____ opportunities to employ it.

a) late b) better
c) future d) spontaneous

v) Humour is called a way of _____, not a part of living.

a) living b) playing
c) nourishing d) developing

Speaking

Complete the following dialogue between a doctor and a patient with ten sets of utterances for the following situation in which a person goes to a doctor for treatment. The doctor wishes to give him/her an injection. The person is scared. The doctor convinces the patient and administers the injection. Now, in pairs, enact the dialogue in the classroom.

5. Answer the following questions in a paragraph of about 80–100 words each.

i) Based on your understanding of the play, explain how a mistaken understanding of events can lead to confusion. How has the author used this unexpected combination of events in the situation to create humour?

ii) Have you ever found yourself in such a situation? Discuss in groups and act out such a situation.

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